

County Administration Workshop: July 7, 2026

1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. District Attorney

1. Axon Justice Contract

Maria Huling, Chief Admin Supervisor- DA presented the District Attorney's request to enter into a long-term Axon Justice software agreement to improve management of digital evidence. Ms. Huling explained that the office currently utilizes Axon's free platform, which limits evidence storage and requires staff to maintain large volumes of digital evidence on local media. The proposed subscription would provide secure cloud-based storage, centralized management of digital evidence, streamlined discovery for defense counsel, automated notifications when additional evidence is received, and vendor-supported training for staff. The software would also eliminate the need to distribute evidence using physical media, improving efficiency in large criminal cases.

Commissioners discussed data ownership, long-term accessibility of evidence, contract termination provisions, and protection of County records. Commissioner Richardson emphasized the importance of ensuring the County retains access to all evidence should the County ever transition to another vendor. Ms. Huling explained that evidence remains available through originating law enforcement agencies and confirmed the agreement had been reviewed by Legal Counsel. She further advised that funding for the subscription had been included in the adopted Fiscal Year 2026-2027 budget. Commissioners expressed support for improving evidence management while encouraging continued oversight of long-term data retention practices.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Axon Justice Contract. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Parks

1. Whitehorse Paving - Aegis Asphalt - \$117,699.00

Tamra Martin, Fairgrounds Director, presented a contract with Aegis Asphalt in the amount of \$117,699.00 to complete paving improvements associated with the Whitehorse Park renovation project. Ms. Martin reported that the project remains on schedule, with the renovated campground anticipated to reopen to the public around September 1, 2026. She explained that the paving work represents one of the final construction phases and includes improvements to campground roads, expanded RV sites, and other infrastructure completed during the renovation. Funding is provided through the Parks Capital Fund, utilizing Land and Water Conservation Fund grant monies together with County reserves.

Discussion included the history of Whitehorse Park, preservation of mature trees during construction, ADA accessibility improvements, installation of new restroom facilities, and collaboration with local recreational organizations to incorporate remote-control vehicle trails into the park's design. Commissioners expressed appreciation for staff's efforts to preserve the character of the park while modernizing facilities and improving accessibility for future visitors.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the Whitehorse Paving - Aegis Asphalt - \$117,699.00. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Community Development

1. Granicus LLC Subscription Invoice \$55,607.63

Frank Wharregard, Building and Planning Manager, presented the annual renewal of the Granicus SmartGov permitting system subscription. Mr. Wharregard explained that Community Development has utilized the platform since 2018 to manage building permits, planning applications, inspections, and digital records. He reported that staff successfully negotiated a new five-year agreement reducing annual subscription increases

from ten percent to five percent while adding integration with Bluebeam software to improve digital plan review efficiency. The updated agreement also converts the County from a limited user license to an enterprise agreement, allowing additional County departments to utilize the software without increasing subscription costs.

Mr. Wharregard further discussed ongoing efforts to digitize historical permit records, integration with GIS and Laserfiche, automated property ownership updates, and implementation of an AI-assisted customer service feature designed to guide applicants through the online permitting process. Commissioners discussed opportunities for additional County departments to utilize the software, benefits of maintaining local digital archives through Laserfiche, and improvements to customer service resulting from expanded online capabilities. Commissioners commended Community Development's efforts to modernize permitting services while maintaining long-term access to County records.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Granicus LLC Subscription Invoice \$55,607.63. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. Public Works

1. ROBCO Invoice \$125,448.76

Richard Pike, Public Works Manager, Public Works Manager Richard Pike presented the remaining Fiscal Year 2026 chip seal material invoice from ROBCO in the amount of **\$125,448.76**. Mr. Pike explained that the crushed aggregate is produced to County specifications for annual chip seal operations and will be used to complete roadway preservation projects throughout the Williams area. He reported that the County expects to complete this year's chip seal program during August and noted that the annual program significantly extends the service life of County roads while reducing long-term maintenance costs.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the ROBCO Invoice \$125,448.76. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. Board Business

a. Board Order No. 2026-039; In the Matter of Separating the Information Technology and Emergency Management Functions of Josephine County and Establishing Separate Department Director Classifications.

Commissioners reviewed Board Order No. 2026-039 formally separating the Information Technology and Emergency Management functions into independent departments. Discussion included previous Board actions that combined the departments and the Board's desire to clearly establish separate departmental leadership through formal Board action. Commissioners agreed that separating the departments would improve organizational clarity and provide a more effective administrative structure. *Commissioner Martin moved to approve Board Order No. 2026-039; In the Matter of Separating the Information Technology and Emergency Management Functions of Josephine County and Establishing Separate Department Director Classifications. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.*

b. Board Order No. 2026-040; In the Matter of Suspending the Acceptance of Applications for Mineral Exploration Permits and Mining Lease.

Commissioners continued discussion regarding the County's Mining Ordinance and the temporary suspension of applications for mineral exploration permits and mining leases. Commissioner Martin expressed support for comprehensively rewriting the ordinance to eliminate outdated provisions, resolve conflicting amendments accumulated over several decades, and reduce potential legal liability. Commissioner Richardson discussed ongoing litigation involving the existing ordinance and emphasized the importance of developing a modern replacement that protects the County while allowing appropriate consideration of future mining proposals. Commissioners agreed that extending the suspension for three months would provide sufficient time to convene Legal Counsel, the Forestry Director, and representatives of the Mining Advisory Committee to evaluate possible revisions and determine whether a rewritten ordinance or alternative permitting process would better

serve the County. Commissioners expressed a desire to avoid future litigation by ensuring any replacement ordinance is clear, consistent, and legally defensible.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve Board Order No. 2026-040; In the Matter of Suspending the Acceptance of Applications for Mineral Exploration Permits and Mining Lease. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. 4H Extension - OSU Service District IGA

Commissioners reviewed the proposed Intergovernmental Agreement between the Josephine County 4-H/Extension Service District and Oregon State University. Discussion centered on the duration of the agreement, legal review, and attachment provisions. Commissioners concluded that additional review by Legal Counsel would be beneficial before execution of the agreement. The matter was **tabled** to a future Legal Update session.

d. 4H Extension District Fund.

Commissioners discussed the expiration of the District's reserve fund and potential future uses of the remaining balance. Discussion included options for reauthorizing the reserve, permissible uses of reserve funds, possible furnishings for the District's new location, and the need to review statutory requirements before taking action. Commissioners agreed to revisit the matter during a future Legal Update with the Finance Director present. The matter was **tabled** pending additional legal and financial review.

3. OTHER

Commissioner Martin provided an update regarding research into replacement of the County's aging radio communications system. Discussion included information obtained from neighboring counties regarding recent communications system modernization projects, including funding methods, infrastructure improvements, and estimated project costs. Commissioners discussed deficiencies identified in Josephine County's current system, including limited coverage in portions of western Josephine County, aging infrastructure, and the need to establish technical specifications before determining funding options.

Commissioners agreed that development of a comprehensive communications system should begin with identifying operational needs for all departments utilizing the County radio network before evaluating financing alternatives. Departments identified for participation included the Sheriff's Office, Corrections, Public Works, Parks, Forestry, Facilities, and Emergency Management. The Board also discussed potential grant opportunities, cooperative purchasing programs, and future financing options.

By consensus, the Board directed staff to schedule a **County Radio Communications Workshop** for **Monday, July 27, 2026, at 10:00 a.m.** in Room 157 to allow affected departments to jointly discuss system requirements, coverage needs, and long-term planning for modernization of the County's emergency communications infrastructure.

4. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

The meeting adjourned at 2:58 p.m.